



The trail from POC to launch

7 → 10 → 20 channels as a proof of concept, into an MVP the sales houses can plug into, a commercial pilot that proves the economics, and a full launch on a production build — with the money mapped at every step, and a plan for growing past FAST.

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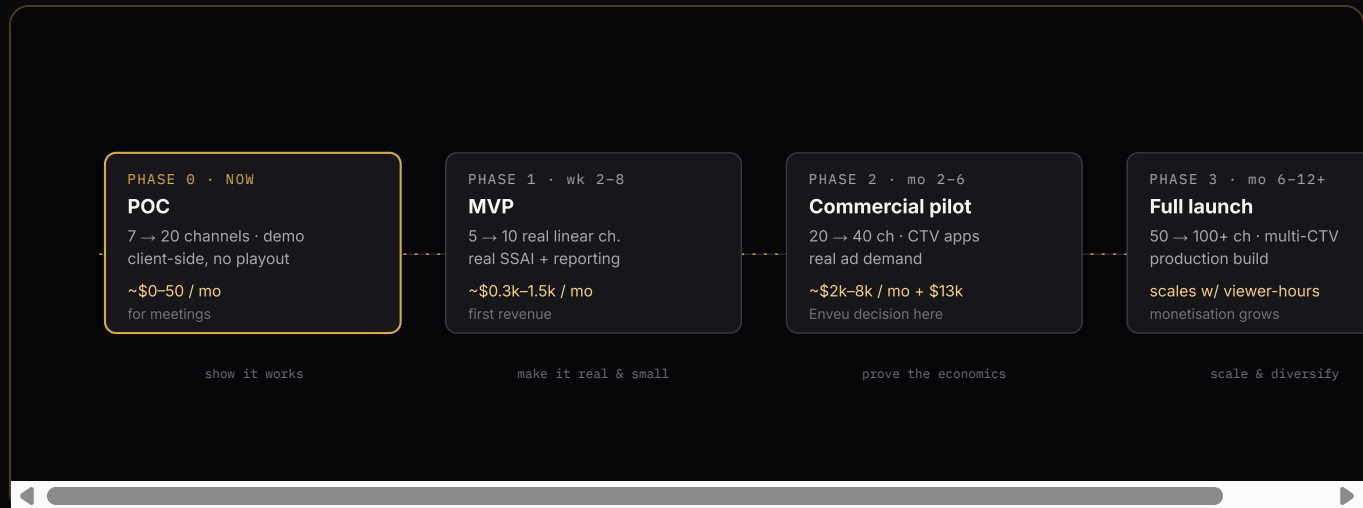
Where we are

The POC scales channels for free. Going from 7 to 10 to 20 is a config change, not a build — it's already done.

BUILD	WHAT IT IS	EFFORT	WHAT IT PROVES
7 channels	First POC — branded player, EPG, ad-break engine, revenue model	done	The product idea and the money model
10 channels	Same, +3 slots (News, Sport, Kids)	done	Room for the first ten partner companies
20 channels	Same, +10 genre slots (Nollywood, Afrobeats, Faith, Comedy, Mzansi, History...)	done	A full-looking bouquet for advertiser & sales-house meetings

What the POC is not: there is no real playout, no ad server, no revenue. Channels are HLS URLs played in a browser; the ad breaks and the earnings panel are a model. It is a *demo* — the right tool for meetings, not a platform.

The trail — four phases



Each phase has a job. You do not build Phase 3 until Phase 2 has shown the numbers work — that is also where the Enveu build (or an in-house team) gets committed, with real data in hand instead of a guess.

PHASE 0 · NOW

POC

now → ~2 weeks

Client-side demo, 7-20 channels, on `asiko.africa`, Asiko-branded. For advertiser, sales-house, partner and investor meetings.

Exit: asiko.africa live · 10+ partners engaged · a demo you can walk into any room with.

GitHub Pages (free) · domain · Eyevinn trial → ~\$0-50/mo

PHASE 1 · WK 2-8

MVP

~6 weeks

Real 24/7 linear playout for 5-10 channels (Eyevinn Channel Engine or self-hosted on the KVM8). Real content — yours + first partner feeds. Eyevinn SGAI ad insertion with a real tag. EPG from a real schedule. Web app hardened, basic analytics, first CTV surface (web-based Roku or PWA).

Exit: 5-10 real channels live · SSAI working with real demand · first invoices out · reporting a sales house trusts.

playout €69-199 · CDN \$50-300 · storage/transcode → ~\$300-1,500/mo + one-off content/transcode

PHASE 2 · MO 2-6

Commercial pilot

PHASE 3 · MO 6-12+

Full launch

~4 months

20–40+ channels, all first partners onboarded. Real ad demand live (SpringServe / Publica + direct sold). CTV apps on 1–3 platforms. Ad-ops function. Content pipeline running. **Decide Enveu here.**

Exit: positive contribution per viewer-hour · repeatable partner onboarding · 100k+ monthly viewer-hours · an ad-sales pipeline.

run-rate ~\$2k–8k/mo (CDN dominates) + CTV apps \$0–40k + Enveu build \$13k one-off + people

ongoing

Enveu-built production platform (or in-house team). 50–100+ channels, multi-CTV, full ad stack + a direct sales house, marketing push. The monetisation model starts to grow past FAST (\$5).

Exit: break-even trajectory · diversified revenue · brand in market.

scales with channels & viewer-hours · CDN is the big line · content spend + team grow

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Milestones that matter to you

The gates — pass each before spending on the next.

#	MILESTONE	PHASE	WHY IT'S A GATE
M1	asiko.africa live with the 20-channel POC on brand	0	You can now sell the vision in a meeting, not a slide
M2	First real linear channel running end to end (playout + SGAI + a real ad tag)	1	Proves the whole pipeline works on real infrastructure — de-risks everything after
M3	First partner channel onboarded from their HLS feed, with reserved ad pods	1	The "List Your Channel" process is real; you can scale partner intake
M4	First revenue — a real invoice, however small	1	Turns a pitch into a P&L line; unlocks investor and sales-house conversations
M5	A sales house or SSP signs on and demand flows to the channels	2	You're no longer selling ads one at a time; fill rate and CPM become the levers
M6	Positive contribution per viewer-hour (revenue after CDN & splits > 0)	2	The unit economics work — now growth is worth funding
M7	CTV apps live on Roku / Fire TV (where the FAST money is)	2	CTV CPMs are 2–4× web; this is where the business becomes real
M8	Enveu build committed (or in-house team hired) with real pilot data	2 → 3	You commit the \$13k + ops spend against proven numbers, not a forecast

#	MILESTONE	PHASE	WHY IT'S A GATE
M9	Break-even trajectory at a known viewer-hours target	3	The platform funds itself; monetisation growth (\$5) becomes upside, not survival

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The financials — so nothing surprises you

FAST infrastructure is cheap. The business is won on **viewer-hours** and **content**, not servers. These figures are illustrative ranges with the assumptions shown — treat them as shape, not forecast.

Running cost by phase

MONTHLY LINE	PHASE 0 POC	PHASE 1 MVP	PHASE 2 PILOT	PHASE 3 LAUNCH
Playout (Eyevinn or KVM8)	\$0 trial	\$75–220	\$220–600	\$600–3k+
Storage	–	\$5–25	\$25–120	\$120–500
Transcode (batch)	–	one-off	\$50–300	\$300–1k
CDN egress (Bunny)	~\$0	\$50–300	\$300–2k	\$2k–15k+
Ad server / SSP	–	rev-share ~10%	rev-share ~10%	rev-share ~10%
Web hosting + domain	\$10	\$12	\$12	\$12
People / ad ops	you	you	1 contractor	ad ops + eng, or Er
Indicative monthly run-rate	~\$0–50	~\$0.3k–1.5k	~\$2k–8k	\$8k–40k+ ($\propto$ view

One-time / capital

- ◆ **Content** — licensing or production. The largest and most variable number, entirely your call. Public-domain + partner feeds keep it near zero to start; a real diaspora catalogue is five to six figures.

- ◆ **Enveu production build** — \$13,000 one-time (revised scope, Eyevinn-native, no AWS), committed at M8.
- ◆ **CTV apps** — a web-based Roku channel can be ~\$0–5k; native apps across Roku / Fire TV / Samsung / LG are \$30k–120k if outsourced, or folded into the Enveu build.
- ◆ **Company, legal, ad-tech contracts** — entity, privacy/consent, listing agreements, SSP onboarding. Low four figures.

The FAST revenue formula

Gross ad revenue $\approx$ viewer-hours $\times$ ad impressions per hour $\times$ (CPM $\div$ 1000) $\times$ fill rate

Worked example (year-1, diaspora CTV assumptions): 24 impressions/viewer-hour $\times$ \$10 CPM $\times$ 50% fill = **\$0.12 gross per viewer-hour**.

Less SSP ~10% and a blended content-owner split (0% on owned channels, ~50% on partner channels) $\approx$ **\$0.06–0.08 net to Asiko per viewer-hour**.

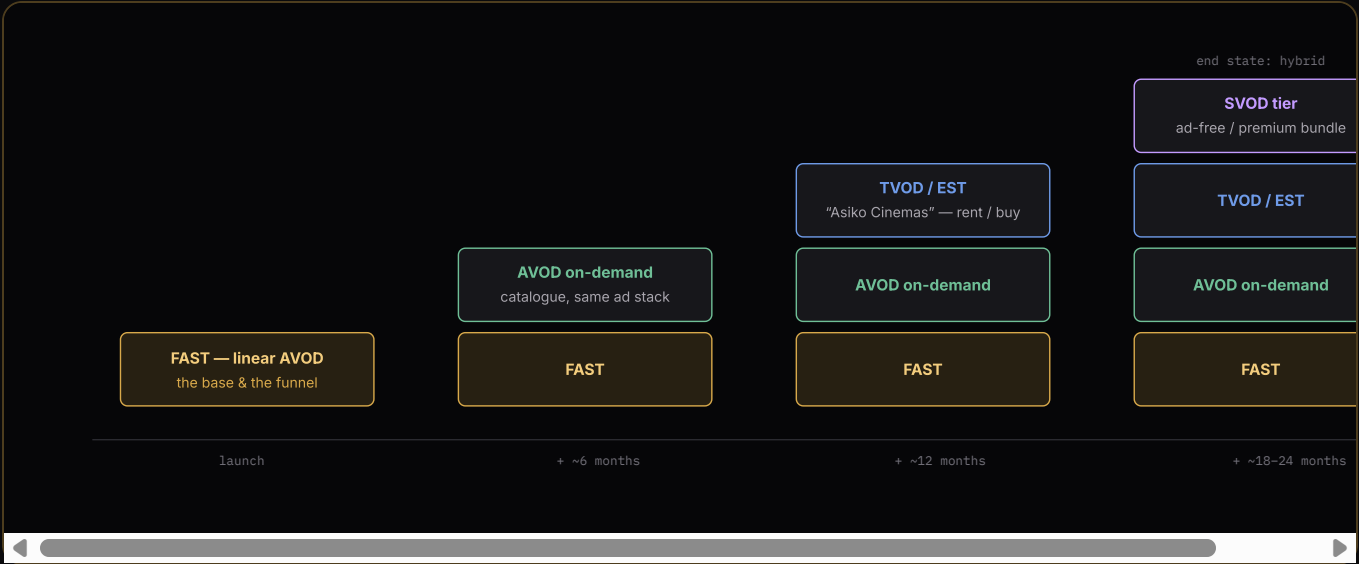
Less CDN at ~1.3 GB/viewer-hour $\times$ ~\$0.01/GB $\approx$ **\$0.013** $\rightarrow$ **contribution $\approx$ \$0.05–0.07 per viewer-hour** before fixed costs.

MONTHLY VIEWER-HOURS	GROSS AD REV	CONTRIBUTION (AFTER CDN & SPLITS)	VS. FIXED COSTS
50,000	~\$6,000	~\$3,000	below Phase-2 fixed — investm
150,000	~\$18,000	~\$9,000	$\approx$ covers Phase-2 fixed
500,000	~\$60,000	~\$30,000	clearly positive — fundable gro
2,000,000	~\$240,000	~\$120,000	a real business

Break-even is a viewer-hours number, not a channel-count number. Roughly **60k–150k viewer-hours a month** covers Phase-2 fixed costs — about 3,000–10,000 regular viewers. CPM, fill and watch-time each swing the result $\pm 50\%$. Adding channels raises the ceiling; it does not move break-even. **Audience acquisition and content are the real spend** — plan for marketing, not just infrastructure.

Growing past FAST — hybrid monetisation

FAST stays the base and the funnel. Each new model is a layer on top — most reuse the same video and ad plumbing; the harder ones add payments, accounts and DRM.



FAST never goes away — it is the free tier that acquires the audience the paid tiers convert from. Add layers only when the one below is generating and the audience is asking for the next.

LAYER	ADDS (REVENUE)	NEEDS (NEW TECH)	LIFT	MAIN RISK
FAST linear	Ad revenue, rev-share with channel partners	— (this is the platform)	—	Fill rate & CPM in a niche market
AVOD on-demand	Higher CPMs (better targeting), more watch-time per user	VOD catalogue + CMS, mid-roll cue points on assets	Low — reuses the ad stack	Content rights for on-demand windows
TVOD / EST "Asiko Cinemas"	Transaction revenue per rental / purchase; premium-title deals	Payments, a storefront, entitlement service, studio-grade DRM (Widevine / FairPlay / PlayReady)	Medium–High	DRM & studio terms; conversion from a free audience

LAYER	ADDS (REVENUE)	NEEDS (NEW TECH)	LIFT	MAIN RISK
SVOD tier	Recurring subscription revenue; predictable ARPU	Subscription billing, accounts / auth, churn & dunning ops, more premium content spend	High	Churn; needs enough exclusive content to be worth paying for
Hybrid (all)	Diversified — ads + transactions + subscriptions	All the above, integrated behind one account & one player	—	Operational complexity; each line needs its own discipline

The build sequence is deliberate: **AVOD on-demand** is nearly free to add and lifts ad revenue, so it comes first. **TVOD / Asiko Cinemas** is the first real new capability (payments + DRM) and a natural premium play for African cinema. **SVOD** comes last — it is a different business discipline and only works once you have an audience and exclusive content worth a monthly fee.

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What this means for you now

- ◆ **Phase 0 is basically done** — finish `asiko.africa` (DNS) and you have your meeting demo, 20 channels, for near zero.
- ◆ ~~Phase 1 needs two unlocks from you — playout access (Eyovinn billing or KVM8 SSH) and first content/partner feeds. Cost is hundreds a month, not thousands.~~
- ◆ **The Enveu \$13k and the CTV-app spend wait until Phase 2** — committed against real pilot numbers, not a forecast.
- ◆ **Budget for audience, not servers.** Break-even is ~60k–150k viewer-hours/month; getting there is a marketing and content spend, and it is the real number to plan around.
- ◆ **Monetisation growth is upside, not the plan.** Get FAST working and funded first; add AVOD-on-demand, then Asiko Cinemas, then SVOD, each only when the layer below is earning.

Asiko TV — trail to launch, financials & monetisation growth

Media Icons Africa · 6 September 2026 · figures are illustrative ranges, not a forecast ·
companion to the revised architecture, design spec, onboarding pack and Week-1 plan